

Spender Versus a Saver

Spenders often marry savers, so this is a common issue. If you're a saver and you open the credit card statement to find that your spouse has bought several hundred dollars' worth of hunting gear when you were planning to use that money for some much needed auto repairs, an argument is almost inevitable. If your spouse constantly nags at you and blames the constant drip of your ATM habits for the huge leak in the budget by month's end, another argument is on its way. When there's a saver and a spender in a relationship, you have to come to a compromise you can both live with.



There are a number of good books about money and relationships, including *Money Harmony: Resolving Money Conflicts in Your Life and Your Relationships* by Olivia Mellan and *Couples and Money: A Couples' Guide Updated for the New Millennium* by Victoria Collins, PhD, and Suzanne B. Brown.

Who Will Do What?

How will you handle your banking? Will you keep separate bank accounts and split the bills between you? Will you share a joint account that all of your income goes into and all of your bills are paid from? It's very difficult to keep track of the transactions that two people make to a single bank account. Many couples find that a joint account for household expenses and individual accounts for each spouse's personal spending works very well ("His," "Hers," and "Theirs"). It allows each of you to have discretionary money for expenditures that you don't have to explain or justify to each other.
